

Chris De La Garza

Staff Solutions Engineer

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SE of the Year · FY25 | 146.5% Quota Attainment · FY26

Infrastructure Engineer turned Solutions Engineer with a decade of building, breaking, and securing systems across bare metal, cloud, and Kubernetes. Known for building demo and enablement systems that outlast the engagement. Today I'm a Staff Solutions Engineer on Teleport's enterprise team and the SE org's Terraform SME.

[EXPERIENCE]

Teleport

Staff Solutions Engineer

Oct 2026 – Present

Staff Solutions Engineer across Teleport's enterprise segment. I own the technical side of complex engagements.

- Own technical pre-sales for strategic enterprise accounts, including solution design from discovery through close
- Terraform SME for the SE organization: reusable modules, the Teleport Terraform provider, and the IaC patterns the team builds on
- Own the demo framework project used for conference demos, aligning technical and non-technical teams on what we demo
- Mentor SEs and run internal training on Terraform and demo delivery
- Build custom demos for emerging capabilities, including Machine & Workload Identity and Beams

Senior Solutions Engineer

Sep 2023 – Oct 2026

- Enterprise pre-sales across AWS, GCP, Azure, and on-prem; closed the **largest deal in company history** (FY25)
 - Named **Solutions Engineer of the Year FY25**; exceeded quota every year at Teleport, including **146.5% attainment in FY26**
 - Designed and authored the teleport-terraform reference architecture, a full IaC template (EKS control plane, RBAC, SCIM, plugins, database access) adopted as the team's standard demo foundation
 - Rebuilt conference demo infrastructure as documented, repeatable playbooks adopted across the SE org, reducing setup time and improving demo consistency at field events
 - Delivered product demonstrations covering SSH, RDP, Kubernetes, database access, and machine identity across complex customer environments
 - Mentored and supported junior SEs on technical architecture and demo delivery
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Cloudflare

Solutions Engineer – Strategic Accounts

Feb 2022 – Sep 2023

- Technical lead for Central and West Field/Strategic teams supporting Fortune 500 accounts
 - North America SME for API Shield, Cloudflare Tunnel, Docker, and Terraform
 - Built new-hire training program that cut SE onboarding from **9 months to 90 days**
 - Created Terraform examples and reusable templates for Cloudflare Tunnels deployment at scale (Terraform + Ansible + Docker)
 - Assisted with team interviews and organizational structure for Strategic SE team buildout
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NGINX, Inc.

Solutions Engineer III

Jun 2021 – Dec 2021

- Collaborated directly with core engineering and product on feature direction for financial and public sector clients
 - Designed hybrid bare-metal-to-cloud solutions involving Kubernetes microservices architecture
 - Co-facilitated NGINX Sprint API management workshop including development, testing, and delivery
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Cloudflare, Inc.

Solutions Engineer

Apr 2019 – May 2021

- Technical sales expert across the full Cloudflare product surface: CDN, DNS, WAF, Bot Management, Workers, Zero Trust
 - Founding member of Austin Mid-Market SE team; helped establish team SOPs and cultural foundation
 - Technical lead supporting up to 15 Account Executives
 - Developed reproducible demos via Terraform/shell scripting/Docker that became standardized tooling for the SE org
 - Led SE booth and back-end demo infrastructure at Cloudflare Connect Conference 2019
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Rackspace

Linux System Engineer II → I → Support

Oct 2015 – Apr 2019

- Managed Linux systems (RHEL/Debian) for dedicated and cloud customers: Apache, MySQL, PHP, DNS, SSH
 - Progressed from L1 support through Linux Sys Engineer II in ~3.5 years
 - Implemented automation to reduce repetitive escalation work; mentored junior technicians
 - Supported environments ranging from single LAMP stacks to large enterprise AWS/Azure/VMware deployments
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[TECH STACK]

Infrastructure: Terraform / OpenTofu · Ansible · Docker / Docker Compose · Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, AKS) · Cloudflare Tunnels

Cloud & Networking: AWS (EC2, EKS, IAM, VPC, S3) · GCP / Azure · Cloudflare (CDN, WAF, Workers, Zero Trust) · DNS, SSL/TLS, BGP basics

Security & Identity: Teleport (PAM / Zero Trust) · Okta (SAML, SCIM, SSO) · mTLS, PKI, certificate management · RBAC / access request workflows

Databases & Apps: PostgreSQL, MySQL / MariaDB · MongoDB, Cassandra · NGINX, Apache · Python (Flask), Bash

[EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS]

Texas A&M University – Corpus Christi

B.B.A., Bachelor of Business Administration · 2011–2014

Dean's List: Spring 2013, Spring 2014

Certifications

> Great Demo! Practitioner